

companies whole in leveraged transactions; others sought board control and eventual liquidation or sale; still others sought only to create the illusion of pursuing control, hoping to be bought out by another acquirer at a premium after putting the company “in play.” Most were either washed away by the 1987 stock market crash or couldn’t find enough undervalued companies in the early 1990s to ply their trade, but a new breed emerged following the dot-com bust in 2000. They found a fertile investment landscape in which overcapitalized technology companies traded at a discount to liquidation value or, in some cases, cash backing. For the first time in more than a decade, the corporate raider was back, but now styled as an activist investor. Icahn again led the charge.

Notes

1. T. Boone Pickens, Jr. *Boone*. (Boston: Houghton Mifflin) 1989.
2. George P. Baker and George David Smith. *The New Financial Capitalists: Kohlberg Kravis Roberts and the Creation of Corporate Value*. (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press) 1998.
3. Pickens, 1989.
4. Ibid.
5. Ibid.
6. Ibid.
7. Michael C. Jensen, “Agency Costs of Free Cash Flow, Corporate Finance, and Takeovers.” *American Economic Review*, May 1986, Vol. 76, No. 2, pp. 323–329.
8. Ibid.
9. Ibid.
10. Pickens, 1989.
11. Ibid.
12. Ibid.
13. Ibid.
14. Ibid.
15. Ibid.
16. Ibid.
17. Ibid.
18. Ibid.
19. Ibid.
20. Ibid.
21. Ibid.
22. Ibid.
23. Ibid.
24. Ibid.
25. Ibid.
26. Ibid.
27. Ibid.